

BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR EXAMINERS

STATE OF COLORADO

Case No. 2021-4108

ORDER OF SUMMARY SUSPENSION

TO: Sandra Ames

The State Board of Licensed Professional Counselor Examiners (“Board”), having reviewed all available information as to the matters referenced below, HEREBY FINDS AS FOLLOWS:

1. The Board has jurisdiction over Sandra Ames (“Respondent”) and the subject matter herein pursuant to the Colorado Mental Health Practice Act, §§ 12-245-101, *et seq.*, C.R.S.

2. Respondent was registered to practice as a licensed professional counselor (“LPC”) in the State of Colorado on June 29, 2012, and was issued license number LPC.6556. Respondent has been so licensed at all times relevant herein and is now so registered.

3. On July 1, 2021, the Board received a complaint from a forensic psychologist alleging that Respondent excessively uses and abuses alcohol, causing the Respondent to suffer memory impairment, confusion, and physical injury.

4. As part of its investigation into these allegations, the Board reviewed the full forensic psychology report regarding Respondent, dated July 1, 2021.

5. Upon full investigation of the documents and information presented regarding case number 2021-4108, the Board finds as follows:

- a. Respondent habitually or excessively uses or abuses alcohol, a habit-forming drug, or a controlled substance, as defined in section 18-18-102(5), C.R.S., in violation of § 12-245-224(e), C.R.S.; and
- b. Respondent failed to notify the board that regulates her profession of a physical illness, physical condition, or behavioral, mental health, or substance use disorder that affect the person’s ability to treat clients with reasonable skill and safety or that may endanger the health or

safety of persons under his or her care, in violation of § 12-245-224(f)(1), C.R.S.

6. Upon full investigation of the documents and information presented, the Board finds objective and reasonable grounds to believe and finds that Respondent is not safe to practice professional counseling with reasonable skill and safety to patients, and the public health, safety, and welfare imperatively requires emergency action. As a result, Respondent's license to practice professional counseling in the State of Colorado must be summarily suspended.

7. The Board hereby summarily suspends Respondent's license to practice professional counseling in the State of Colorado pursuant to §§ 24-4-104(4) and 24-4-105(12), C.R.S.

8. Respondent cannot engage in the practice of professional counseling in the State of Colorado or hold herself out as able to practice professional counseling in the State of Colorado while her license is suspended.

9. Any violation of this Order constitutes a violation of a lawful Board Order and may be grounds for further proceedings pursuant to §§ 12-245-224 and -226, C.R.S. The pendency of any disciplinary action shall not affect the obligation of Respondent to comply with this Order.

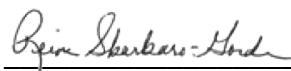
10. This Order does not resolve any other cases, complaints, or matters, known or unknown to the Board or Respondent, as of the effective date of this Order.

11. This Order shall be a public record in the custody of the Board.

THEREFORE, pursuant to the above, IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that the license of Sandra Ames to practice professional counseling in the State of Colorado is suspended.

EFFECTIVE this 15 day of July, 2021.

STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL
COUNSELOR EXAMINERS



REINA SBARBARO-GORDON
Program Director